Why this segment

At Cometlab.ai, which sells similar services in India, the businesses that came looking for this help were manufacturers and distributors ⟦one general line on what you saw; no client names or numbers⟧. I tested that against Australia:

- **Size and fit.** About 10,800 wholesalers turn over A$2–10M (ABS); I estimate 6,700 in A$3–10M. That's 16% of all wholesalers in the band, against 7% for trades (ABS), so more Meta responders are worth calling.
- **Qubik's edge.** Landed cost, stock values and import GST all land in the Xero file an accountant reads monthly, and Qubik is a Xero Platinum partner (Xero).
- **Live pressure.** The ACCC reports record stevedoring charges flowing through to importers (ACCC, Dec 2025).

Trades, pubs, labour hire and job-shop manufacturers lost on band share, crowding, margins or build risk.

1. Buyer and problem

Organisation. Buys from overseas factories, holds stock here, sells to trade or retail (hardware, electrical, lighting, auto parts, packaging, homewares, food). A$3–10M revenue, 10–40 staff. They say "we're the Australian distributor for…", not "importer-distributor".

Decision-maker. The owner or MD signs. The finance or office manager, or external bookkeeper, carries weight.

The problem. A container's costs don't arrive with the container. The supplier invoice comes first, the freight bill later, and the customs broker's invoice with duty and GST can come weeks after the stock is on the shelf. Software like Unleashed can spread these costs and even recalculate margin after sale (Unleashed), so the software isn't the gap. The gap is someone chasing three parties' paperwork, and prices only being reviewed once it's in. In Xero-only or MYOB shops it lives in a spreadsheet, if anywhere. It repeats with every container, and meanwhile stock sells at last quarter's price.

Likely cost (estimate, replaced by real numbers in the diagnostic). A A$6M distributor with A$3.6M of imported sales: a 5% landed-cost rise recovered three months late costs about A$45k. Two a year is about A$90k of margin, before the hours spent chasing paperwork.

Buying triggers. A freight or currency jump, a quarter where margin "went missing", the bookkeeper leaving, a stocktake that won't reconcile. And now: Christmas stock is landing, and orders ahead of Chinese New Year (6 Feb 2027) go to factories in November (Sino-Shipping).

Ability to pay. At this size, A$57–90k is a normal investment if it pays back in about a year, which the diagnostic tests. Cash is checked on the first call.

Why Meta. Owners use Facebook personally, so Meta reaches them; since 2025's targeting changes it can't identify them (Meta changes). The hook and form filter: only an importer recognises the problem, and dropshippers and employees fail the questions.

2. Offer and proof

The Container Cost Check. A$3,500 + GST, founding-client price. Three weeks, fixed scope. The client receives:

1. **Their last three to five shipments, costed properly** from the real documents.
2. **The gap in dollars:** true cost against system cost and actual sell price, product by product.
3. **The lag:** days from container arrival to fully costed, and who spends how long chasing paperwork.
4. **A fixed-price plan** to have costs worked out the day the paperwork lands, with payback.
5. **A one-hour sit-down with the owner** and a short report.

They provide read-only Xero access, recent shipment documents and two hours of staff time.

On price. A "was A$7,500" claim must reflect a price actually charged (ACCC), so I'd say "A$3,500 for our first ten clients, A$7,500 after", once Qubik commits.

Proof at launch, all real. Xero Platinum partner since 2013, CA ANZ and CPA memberships (Xero) ⟦confirm⟧. The automation specialist, named, with something they've built ⟦ask Qubik⟧. A sample report on labelled dummy data. And the founding-client deal: ten clients get the price in exchange for anonymised before-and-after results, so proof is built, not invented.

Bridge to implementation. The diagnostic's dollar figure becomes the business case for a build already scoped and priced in the report, with the A$3,500 credited if they proceed within 30 days. A typical build captures supplier, freight and broker documents from the inbox, matches them to the shipment, posts landed cost to Unleashed, Cin7 or Xero, and lists products now below target margin each week. Staff approve anything uncertain. Systems and supplier count set where it lands in A$57–90k.

3. Meta acquisition

Objective. Leads, on a "higher intent" Instant Form (adds a review step). Facebook and Instagram feeds and Reels; Audience Network off, as that's where junk leads come from. A$900 over 14 days.

Audience. One ad set (splitting A$900 starves every cell): Australia, 30–65+, broad, with signals like importing, wholesale, freight forwarding, Unleashed or Cin7. Qubik clients excluded. Test two: 1-mile pins over port-side warehouse estates (Eagle Farm, Wetherill Park, Dandenong South, Kewdale). Month three: gift and homewares trade fairs, where nearly every exhibitor imports.

Creative. A real Qubik accountant, filmed on a phone beside a desk of shipping paperwork, talking plainly about a gap owners feel but rarely measure.

First test. Three hooks in one ad set, Meta deciding spend: (A) “Freight went up again. Did your prices?” (B) “The container’s landed. Do you know what it actually cost?” (C) “The broker’s invoice turned up three weeks after the stock. Sound familiar?” Judged on cost per qualified lead. Directional, but it shows which pain brings the right people.

Sample ad (hook A): > **Freight went up again. Did your prices?** > > When a container lands, the costs don’t arrive with it. The supplier invoice comes first, the freight bill later, and the broker’s invoice weeks after that. Until someone pulls it together, nobody knows what the stock really cost, and it’s selling at last quarter’s price. > > We’re Qubik, Xero Platinum accountants in Brisbane. We’ll rebuild the true cost of your last few containers, show you where margin slipped, and what it would take to have it worked out the day the paperwork lands. > > Three weeks, fixed fee. A$3,500 + GST for our first ten clients. > > For Australian distributors who import their own stock.

Lead form. Name, mobile, work email, company, and consent, plus a privacy policy link, which Meta requires. Then five questions:

Tests	Question	Answers
Need/fit	Do you import your own stock?	Yes, by the container · Yes, smaller shipments · No
Need	What runs your stock and invoicing?	Xero only · MYOB · Unleashed or Cin7 · Something else
Size	Annual revenue	Under A$2M · A$2–5M · A$5–10M · Over A$10M
Authority	Your role	Owner/MD · GM or operations · Finance or office manager · Other
Urgency and budget	If a fix paid for itself within a year, could you fund it in the next six months?	Yes, soon · Probably · Not now / just looking

4. Qualification, nurture and handover

Scoring. At four to six leads a human calls everyone; tiers set priority. Gates: imports, revenue A$2M+, role not “Other”. **Qualified:** passes and says “Yes, soon” or “Probably”. **Review:** passes but says “Not now”, or is over A$10M. **Nurture:** fails a gate; monthly email. At volume it becomes a points score fed back to Meta.

Six events from form to sales:

#	Event	What happens	Owner
1	Lead arrives	In the CRM within a minute: cleaned, de-duplicated, tiered, consent and source ad recorded.	Automation
2	Reply within 5 minutes	SMS and email from a named Qubik accountant with a booking link. Review tier: a same-day call instead.	Automation; copy by Marketing
3	Call within 15 minutes (business hours)	Check the uncertain answers, book them on the spot.	Sales
4	Booked	Booking stops every chaser; two pre-call questions (what they sell, when the last container landed). Unbooked: email day 1, SMS day 3, email day 6, then monthly.	Automation
5	Reminders and no-shows	Email the day before, SMS two hours before, both with a reschedule link. No-show: SMS after 10 minutes, email next day, call day 3, then monthly.	Automation; call by Sales
6	Handover	One-page brief: answers, ad seen, all messages. Sales accepts or rejects within a business day, with a reason I review weekly.	Sales, with Marketing

Rules. *Duplicates:* matched on mobile, email or company; merged, never restarted; Qubik clients go to their accountant. *Replies:* pause automation; a person answers within two business hours. *Opt-outs:* STOP or unsubscribe removes them everywhere immediately (law allows five working days, ACMA); every message identifies Qubik. *Uncertain answers:* never auto-rejected. *Escalation:* complaints, privacy, price negotiation or automation failures go to a named person.

Ownership. Marketing (me): ads, form, tiers, copy, nurture, reporting. Automation (Qubik's specialist and IT): CRM, routing, messaging, consent records. Sales (Qubik): calls, lead acceptance, closing.

First email: > **Subject:** Your container costs, {FirstName} > > Hi {FirstName}, thanks for getting in touch. From your answers, {Company} is exactly who we built the Container Cost Check for. Next step is a 20-minute call with me about how your shipments get costed today, and whether the check is worth doing. Grab a time: {link}, or reply and I'll work around you. > > {Rep}, Qubik Accounting · {unsubscribe}

First SMS: > Hi {FirstName}, it's {Rep} from Qubik about your container costs enquiry. Book a quick call here: {link} Reply STOP to opt out

5. Economics and downside

The brief's rates, all applied to qualified leads, with A$73.5k as the midpoint implementation:

	A$150 CPL	**A$225 CPL**
Leads (A$900 ÷ CPL)	6	4
Qualified (30%)	1.8	1.2
Attended (70% of qualified)	1.26	0.84
Diagnostics (50% of qualified)	0.9 = A$3,150	0.6 = A$2,100
Implementations (25% of qualified)	0.45 = A$33,075	0.3 = A$22,050
Gross attributed revenue	**A$36,225**	**A$24,150**

At A$57k–90k implementations the totals range A$28,800–43,650 and A$19,200–29,100.

Reading it straight. A$900 buys four to six leads, so the real result is nothing or one sale; it tests the funnel. The rates are generous: 7 in 10 attendees buying a diagnostic, and half of those going on to build. And revenue is almost all implementation, arriving two to four months later.

The plan I'd hold us to:

By	**Expect**	**If not**
A$450 spent	At least 2 leads, at least 1 qualified	Change the hook
A$900 spent	CPL at or under A$225, at least 30% qualified, at least 1 call booked	See below
Day 30	At least 1 diagnostic sold	Proof and offer

Main risk: lead quality, not lead cost. Each lead is worth about A$6,000 at the brief's rates, so even a A$600 CPL works if 30% qualify. A form full of people who'll never buy drags qualification to 10–15%, and everything downstream shrinks.

What I'd change first: the filter. If qualification is low, tighten the callout ("for distributors who import by the container") and move revenue to the first question. Only then, in order: the hook and video if CPL is high, response speed if the right people don't book, proof and terms if they book but don't buy.

6. Priorities, assumptions and AI

First 14 days:

1. **Check the ground (days 1–5):** reach and age spread in Ads Manager, an Ad Library scan, five calls with distributors Qubik knows ⟦confirm⟧, the specialist's sign-off on delivering in three weeks at a profit.
2. **Launch-ready, and break the funnel on purpose (days 3–8):** privacy policy, a live-looking Qubik page, an accountant willing to be filmed, founding terms signed off, section 4 tested with dummy leads, sales committed to 15-minute calls.
3. **Run the test (days 8–14+):** daily checks, the A$450 read, sales feedback on every lead.

Assumptions to validate: audience size; that late costing really hurts at this size; document access; willingness to pay A$3,500, then A$57–90k; sales capacity; my cost estimate and band split; pricing, consent and privacy compliance.

What I did, what AI did, how I checked ⟦must be accurate. Edit freely⟧.

- **Me:** the segment came from my Cometlab experience, then testing. I rejected the AI's first two picks (trades, job-shop manufacturers), sent back one draft for sounding machine-written and another for chasing three problems at once. ⟦Add your own calls.⟧
- **Claude (Anthropic), via Claude Code:** summarised the brief, ran Python on ABS business counts, searched sources, drafted text I rewrote.
- **Checks:** spot-checked ABS figures in the source file, recalculated the economics by hand, opened every source and cut what I couldn't back, checked ad length and ACCC/ACMA rules.